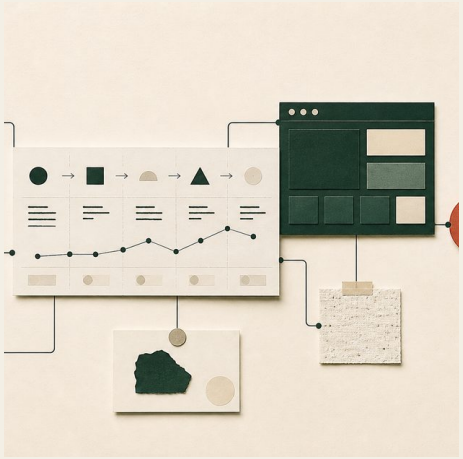
WUYUAN GAO

I research complex services and turn findings into *clear, testable proposals.*

Service design / design research / journey design / working prototypes



BASED IN LONDON

Available now

Open to graduate, junior and associate roles in London, including fixed-term and part-time contracts.

PROFILE

Research, visual communication and working prototypes.

My background combines service-design research with visual communication and browser prototyping. I build prototypes with AI coding assistance; the research, flows and interface decisions are mine. I separate observations, assumptions and open questions, then use them to decide what should be designed and tested next.

CAPABILITIES

01 Field research

02 Qualitative synthesis

03 Service framing

04 Journey design

05 Figma

06 Browser prototyping

07 Visual communication

08 Prototype evaluation

SELECTED WORK

01 Month-End Buffer

Independent service research

02 Protection Preview

Financial services collaboration

03 Ritual Rewrite

Heritage learning service

04 Myco-Care

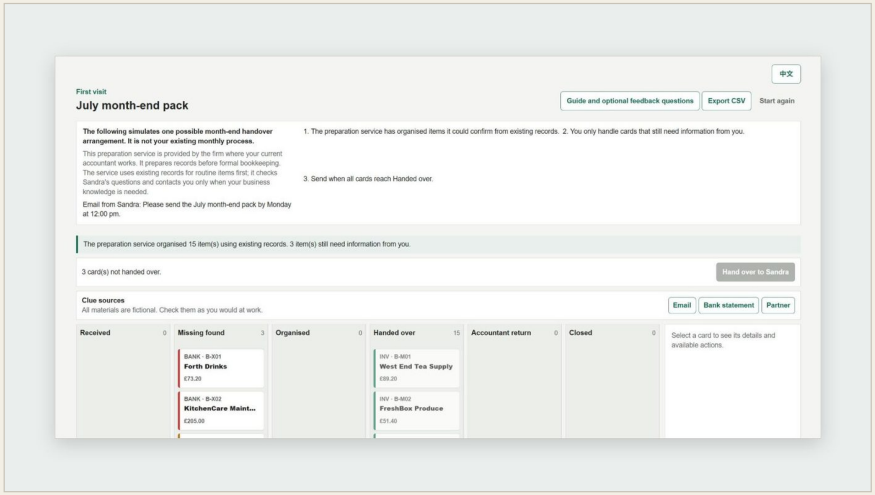
Systems study

INDEPENDENT SERVICE RESEARCH / 2026

Month-End Buffer

A service proposal that makes visible who absorbs the preparation, interruption and uncertainty around a small business's month-end accounting.

OPEN WORKING SIMULATOR



The browser rehearsal in use: 15 items organised by the preparation service, 3 still needing the owner's information.

ROLE

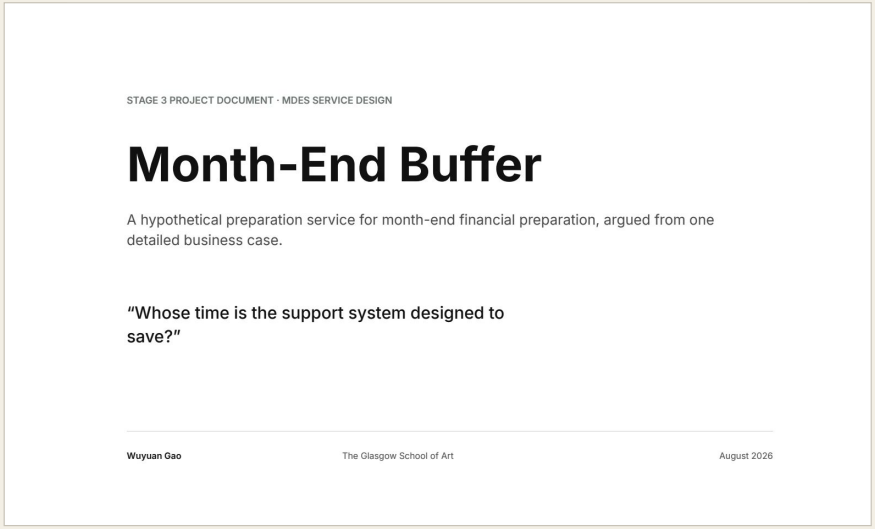
Individual Service Designer and Researcher

METHODS

Field mapping / light-touch contact / one owner case / responsibility mapping / prototype trial

DURATION

June - August 2026


STAGE 3 PROJECT DOCUMENT · MDES SERVICE DESIGN

Month-End Buffer

A hypothetical preparation service for month-end financial preparation, argued from one detailed business case.

"Whose time is the support system designed to save?"

Wuyuan Gao — The Glasgow School of Art — August 2026

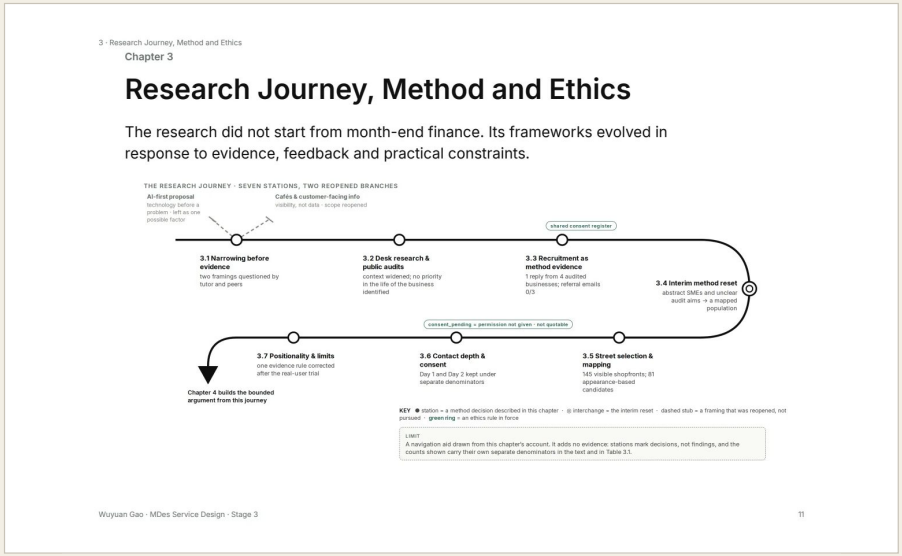
Stage 3 project document: research, service rehearsal and evidence limits.

RESEARCH RESET

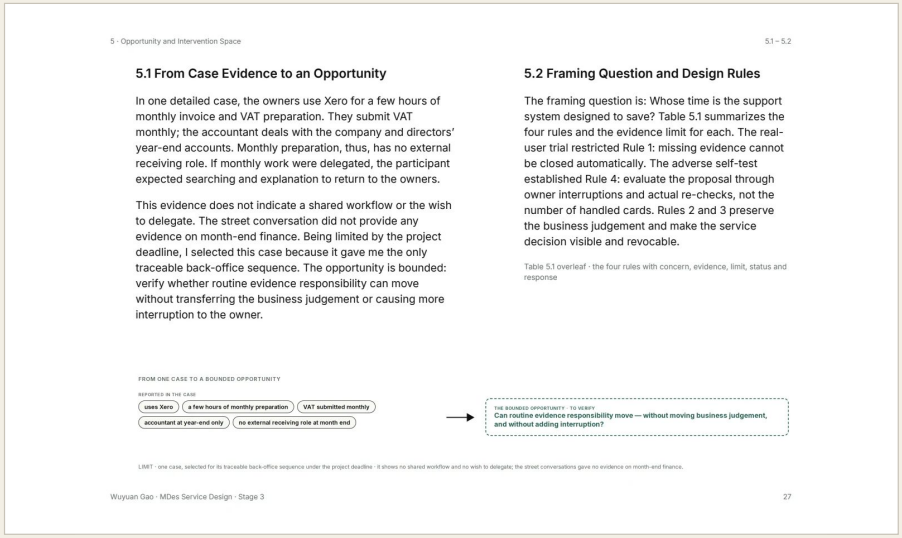
Fieldwork showed that the initial research question was too broad.

Desk research and online audits could describe a topic, but not identify a specific service problem supported by evidence. I reset the method, mapped 145 street-facing units and completed two days of light-touch fieldwork. The sample described an observable local context; it did not prove that every unit shared one operational problem.

What can the evidence support - and what must the design leave open?



The research journey records where the question changed after critique.



Claims, counterevidence and limits were visible before an opportunity was selected.

CASE EVIDENCE

One owner case changed the question from software adoption to responsibility.

The owners prepared monthly invoices and VAT material before an accountant entered records. Delegating more work was not automatically helpful: searching, explaining and answering follow-up questions could return work to the business in another form.

Whose time is the support system designed to save?

OPPORTUNITY

Test whether a preparation role could absorb routine evidence handling without silently returning checking and explanation work to the owner.

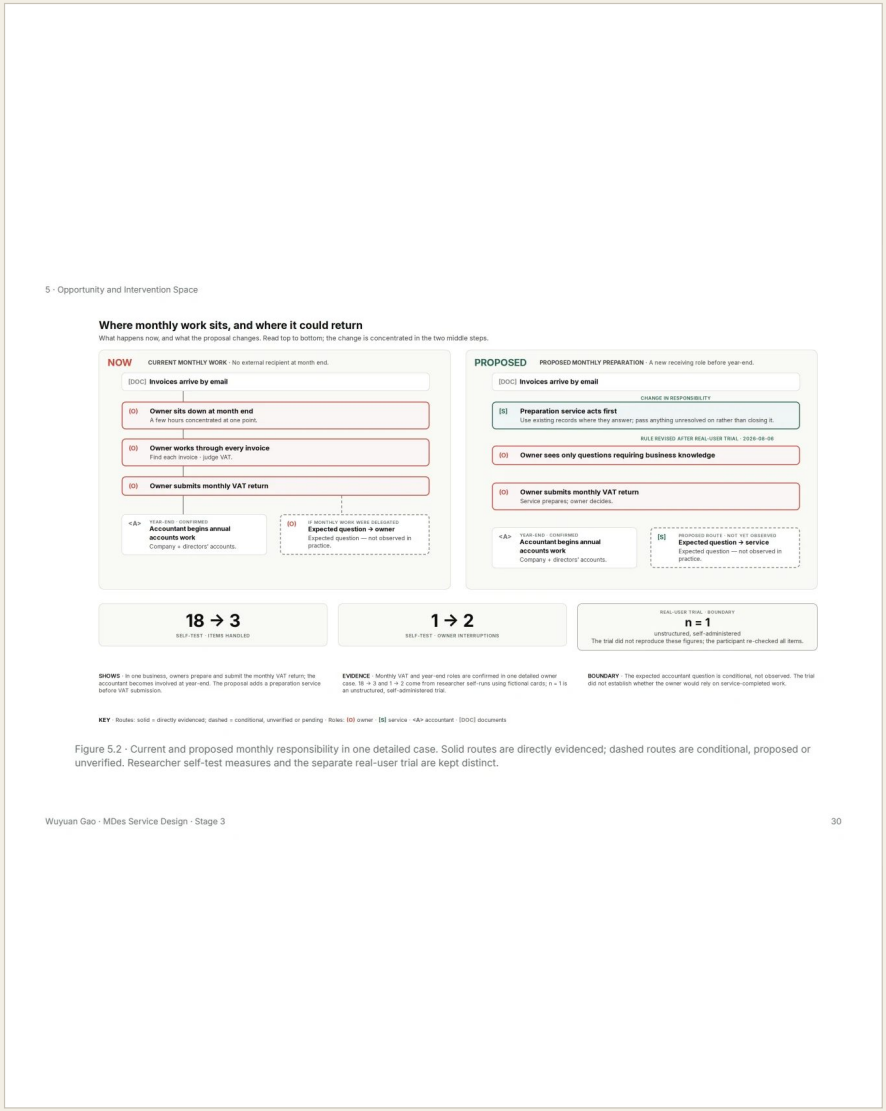


Figure 5.2 · Current and proposed monthly responsibility in one detailed case. Solid routes are directly evidenced; dashed routes are conditional, proposed or unverified. Researcher self-test measures and the separate real-user trial are kept distinct.

The design object is the distribution of responsibility, not another dashboard.

SERVICE RESPONSE

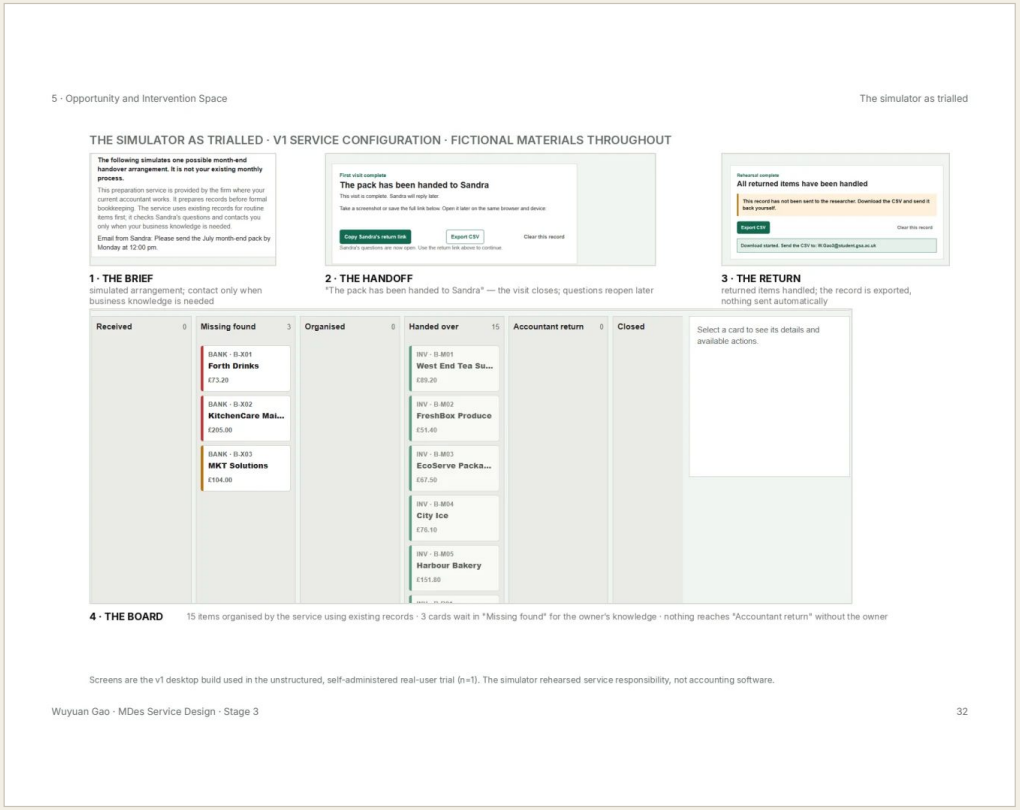
Two matched configurations made the invisible work comparable.

Owner-led: the owner organises material and receives every follow-up question.

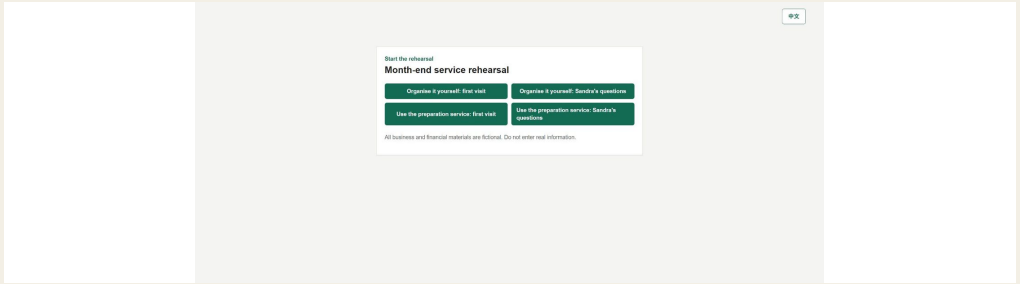
Service-absorbed: a preparation role applies fixed rules, records its evidence basis and returns only decisions requiring business judgement.

DESIGN DECISION

The interfaces remain deliberately similar. The meaningful difference is who holds the interruption, uncertainty and follow-up work.



The browser-based rehearsal uses fictional emails, bank items and partner documents.



Four routes let a participant compare first-visit and return states.

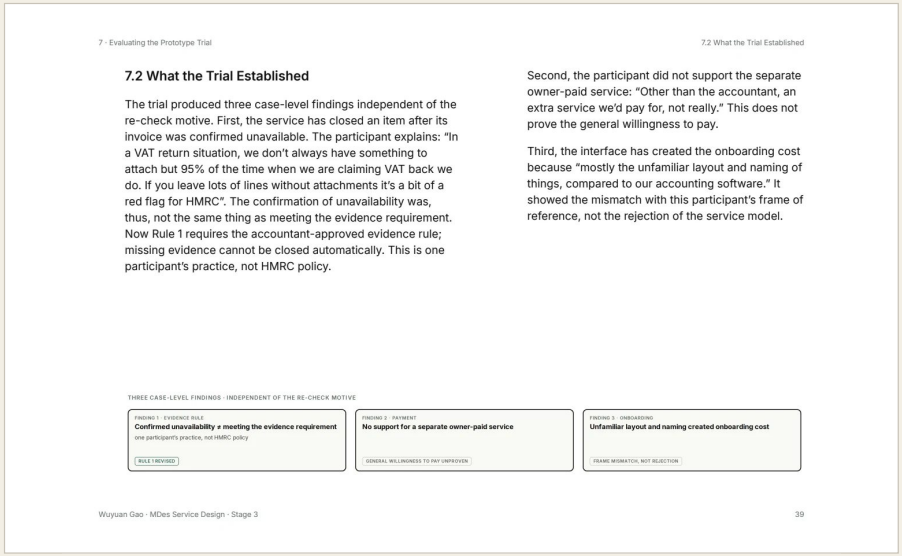
TRIAL, LEARNING AND LIMITS

The trial clarified what needed to be tested next.

One co-owner completed the service-absorbed route asynchronously. They could allow fixed-rule handling without seeing every intermediate check, but did not support paying for a separate owner-facing service outside the accounting relationship. The handoff language also remained unclear.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

No Glasgow-wide need, business impact, commercial viability or accounting accuracy is claimed. The project rests on one detailed owner case and one unmoderated run.



Case-level findings are separated from commercial claims.

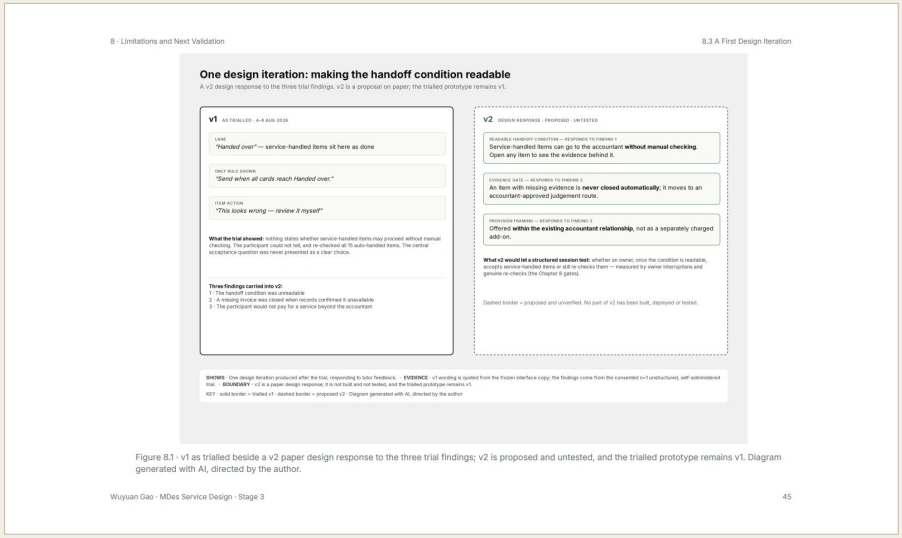


Figure 8.1 · v1 as trialled beside a v2 paper design response to the three trial findings; v2 is proposed and untested, and the trialled prototype remains v1. Diagram generated with AI, directed by the author.

The next iteration clarifies what the service handles and when the owner is contacted.

SCOTTISH WIDOWS COLLABORATION / 2026

Protection Preview

A low-pressure experience that explains protection, buying and claiming before a person is asked to enter a quote journey.

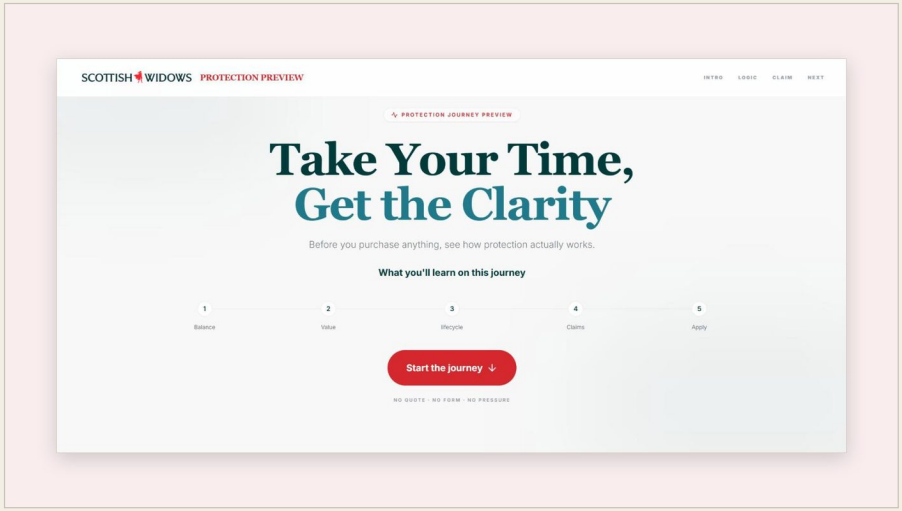
OPEN FINAL GROUP WEBSITE **WATCH PROJECT VIDEO**

MY ROLE

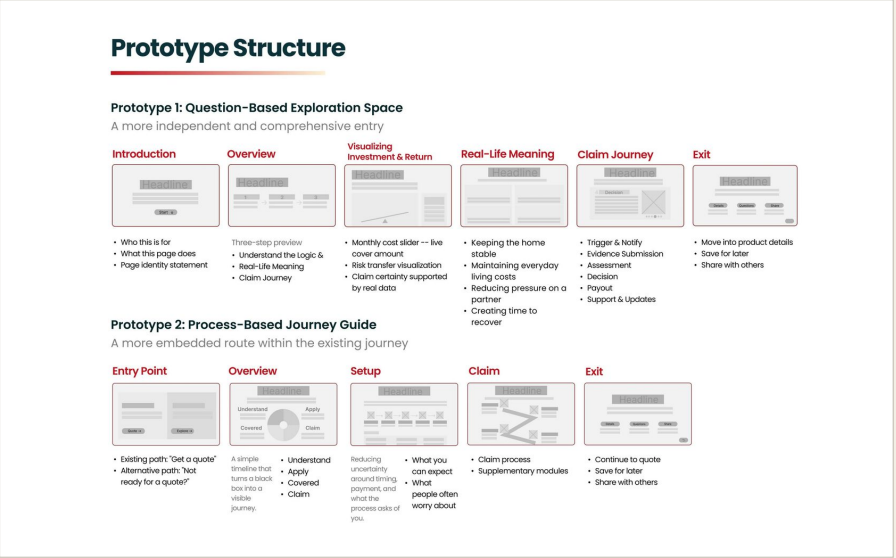
Service Designer; owner of Prototype 2's flow, interaction and visual design, browser build (with AI coding assistance) and iteration.

TEAM AND DURATION

Five-person team, Glasgow School of Art x Scottish Widows. 12 weeks, January to April 2026.



Final group outcome: Take Your Time, Get the Clarity.



The prototypes tested two different positions before and within the quote journey.

RESEARCH AND REFRAME

The problem was not simply that protection needed simpler words.

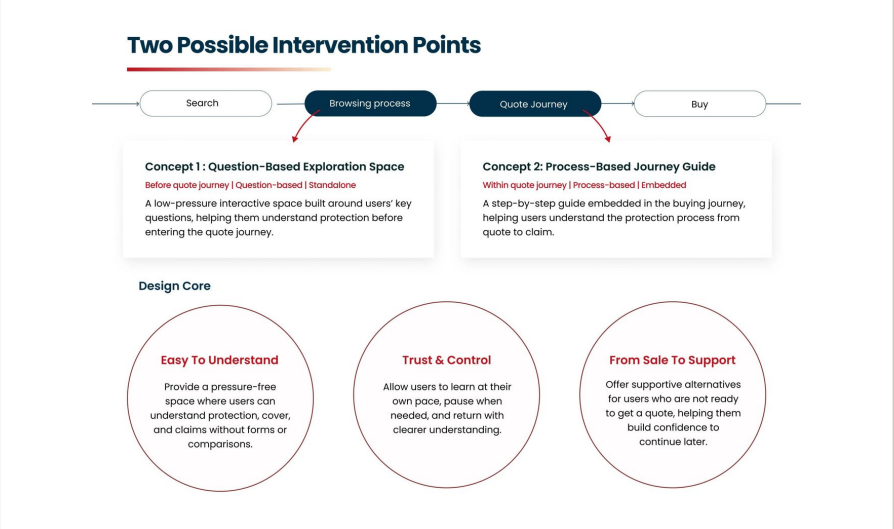
Public engagement identified different barriers: cost, relevance, family responsibility, uncertainty about claiming, discomfort around health history and fear of losing control in a form-led journey. The critical moment was before the quote, when interest was present but clarity and confidence were unstable.

DESIGN INTENT

Explain the process before requesting commitment, acknowledge uncertainty without fear, and preserve user control over when to continue.



The findings showed that barriers differed between participants.



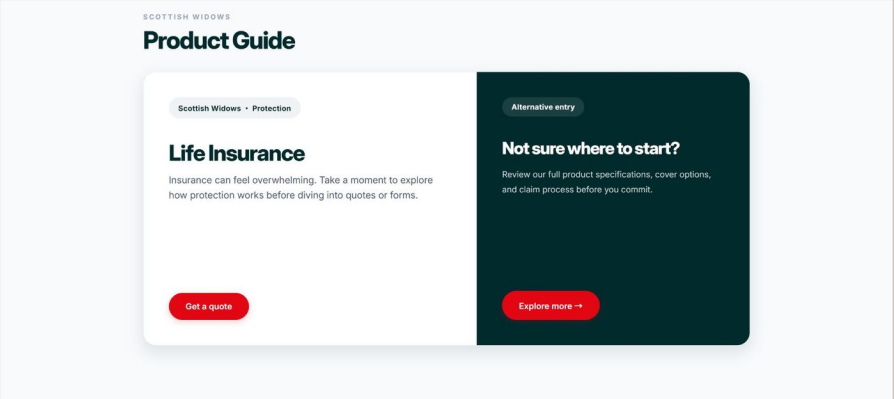
Two intervention points: a stand-alone exploration space and a process guide.

MY INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTION

Prototype 2 showed the buying and claiming process step by step.

I owned Prototype 2: its user flow, page architecture, visual and interaction design, browser testing and iteration after feedback. I built it in HTML, CSS and JavaScript with AI coding assistance and published it on GitHub Pages.

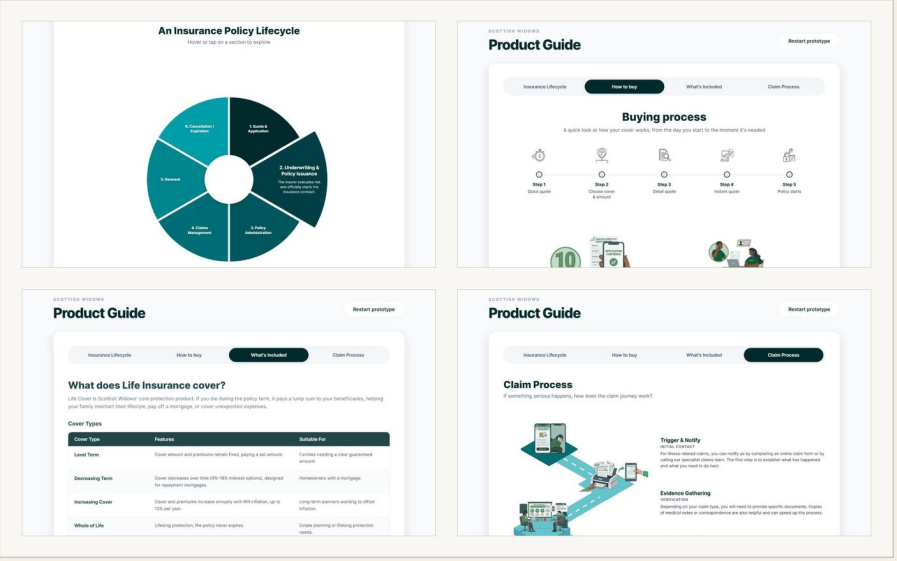
OPEN MY PROTOTYPE 2



My Prototype 2 offered a lower-pressure alternative entry to product information.

WHAT TESTING CHANGED

The process was clearer, but the experience still felt too close to starting a quote. This informed the final stand-alone group direction.

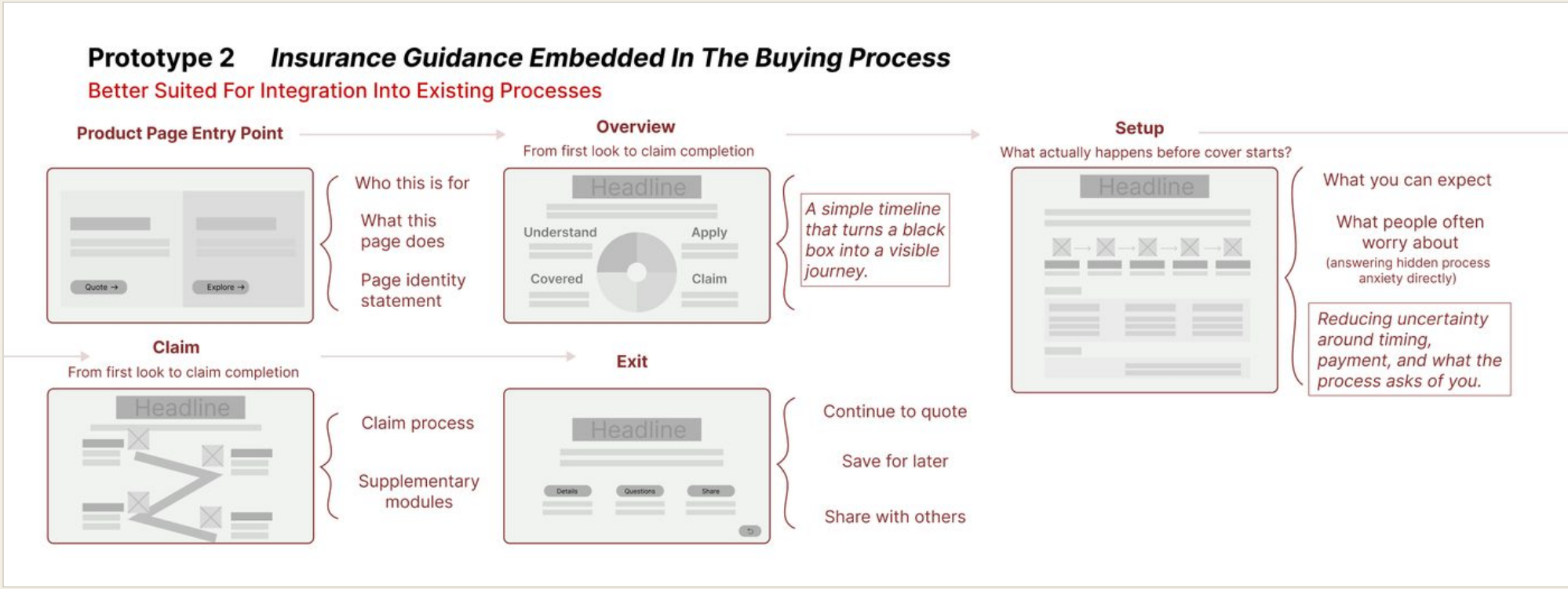


A staged guide shows the lifecycle, buying, cover and claim process.

FROM WIREFRAMES TO BROWSER

Low-fidelity wireframes set the page sequence before the browser build.

I worked from an information architecture to low-fidelity wireframes in Figma. I took the wireframes to our tutor's weekly session and to another student team, revised them, and then built the browser version, which I presented to another student team and to Scottish Widows staff.



Prototype 2 wireframes: product page entry point, overview, setup, claim and exit.

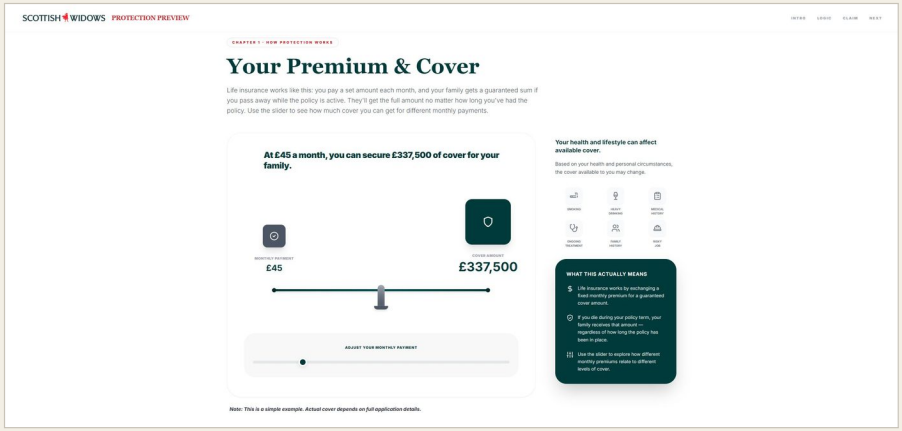
FINAL GROUP OUTCOME

The final website explains protection before introducing a quote.

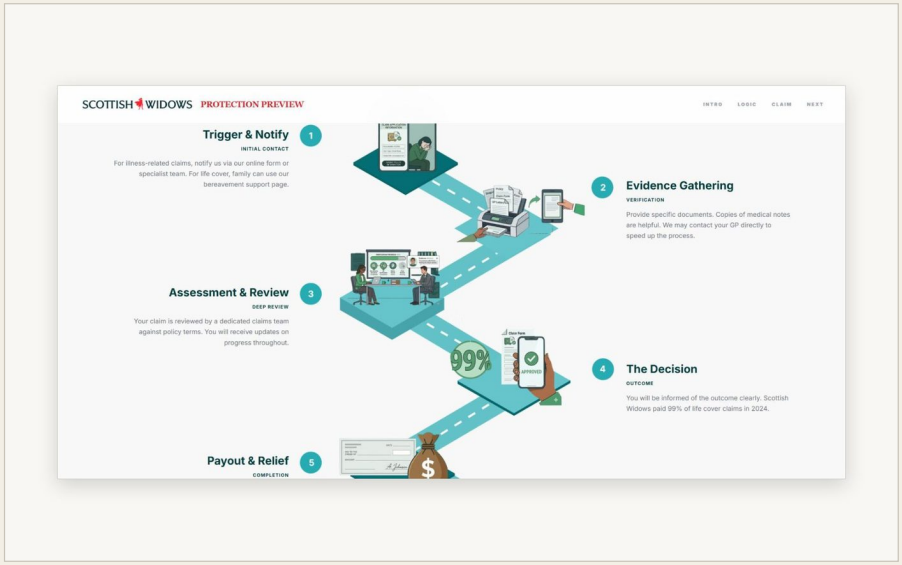
Protection Preview lets people explore premiums and cover, real-life value, policy lifecycle, claims and buying without first entering personal details. The final positioning is explicit: no quote, no form and no pressure.

COMBINED STRENGTHS

The final group website combines Prototype 1's stand-alone exploration with the process visibility developed in my Prototype 2.



An interactive premium-and-cover example includes an illustrative-data note.



A six-stage claim journey makes an unfamiliar process visible.

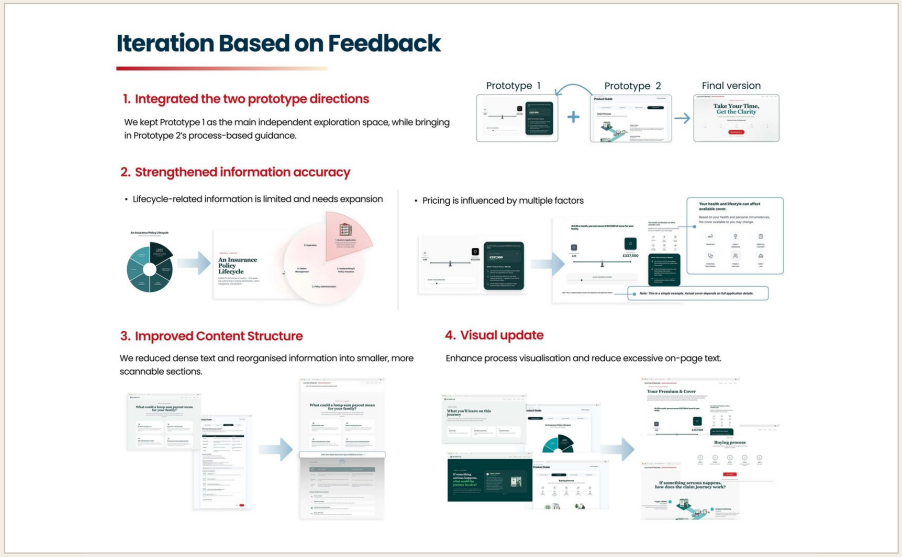
ITERATION, LEARNING AND LIMITS

For regulated services, clarity depends on timing and user control.

Peer and stakeholder feedback improved product definition, information accuracy, scanning and visual guidance. A second test found the purpose clear, while the connection to the brand, concrete scenarios and personalisation needed more work.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

This was a research and learning prototype, not a deployed Scottish Widows service. No conversion, underwriting, commercial or customer-impact claim is made.



Accuracy, content structure and visual clarity were iterated together.



Final testing supports learning, not a commercial-impact claim.

HERITAGE LEARNING SERVICE / 2025

Ritual Rewrite

A no-login browser game and printable teacher guide designed for short classroom sessions about gendered heritage.

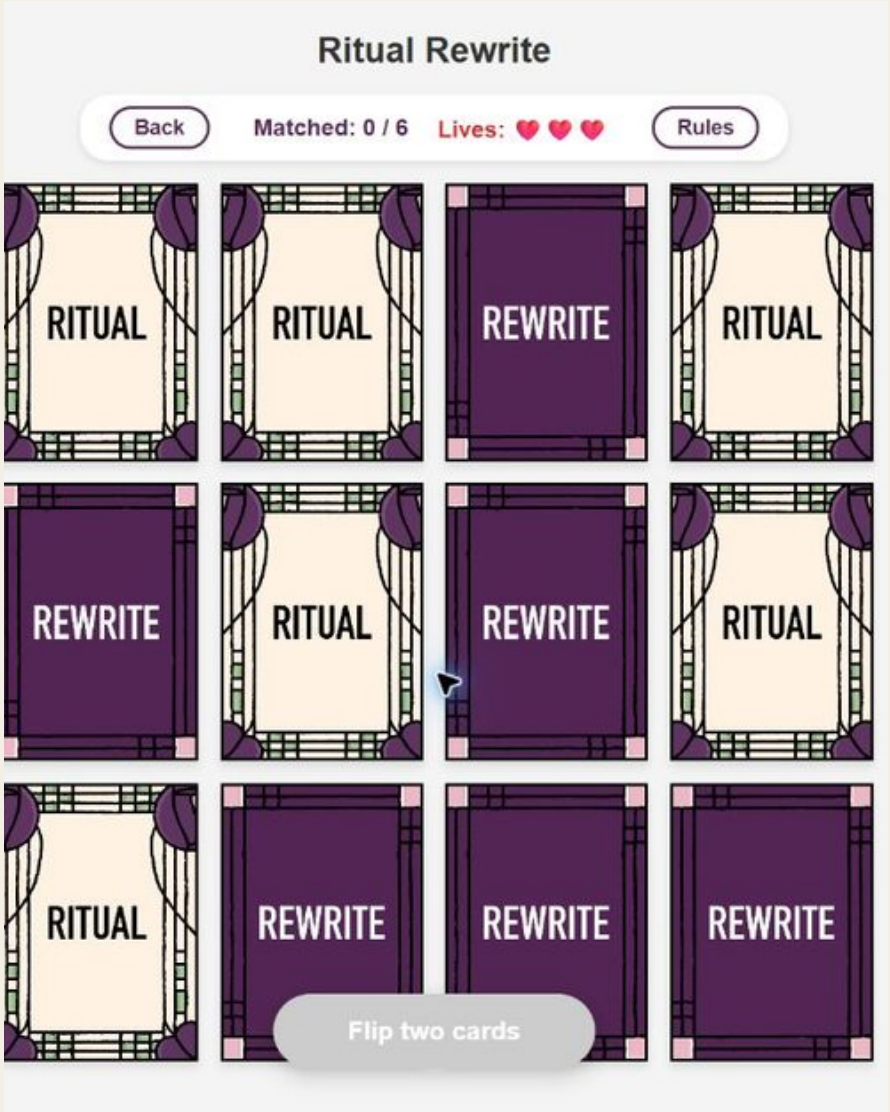
OPEN WORKING GAME

ROLE

Service Designer; built the browser game with AI coding assistance

TEAM AND DURATION

Five-person multidisciplinary team. Studio 1 project, 2025.



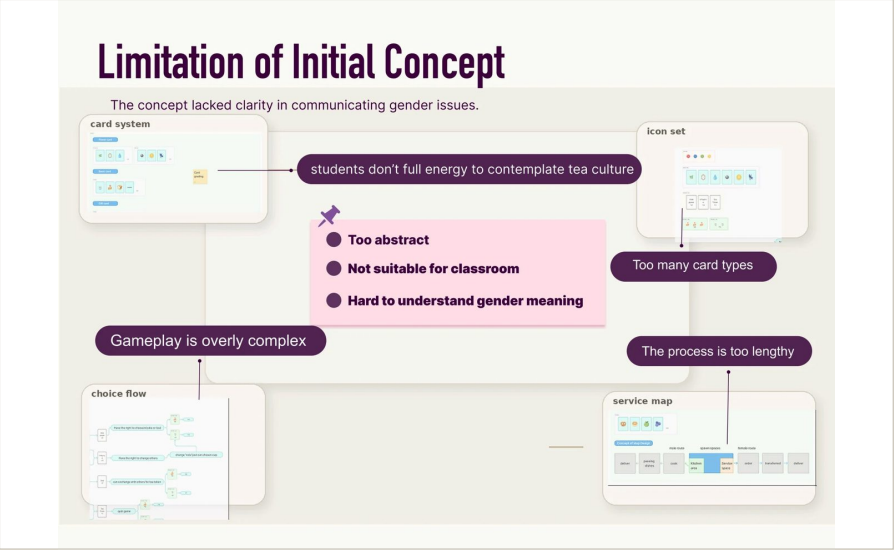
Working Level 1 browser game with twelve ritual cards and three lives.

RESEARCH INTO INTERACTION

Early prototype failures clarified the interaction requirements.

Tea-Time Bias Bingo failed because categories were interpreted inconsistently. A digital health-point mechanic created urgency but could overwhelm the learning purpose. Long historical paragraphs could not simply be transferred into short cards.

The team needed enough tension to prompt discussion, while still allowing students to pause, read and interpret.



The initial concept was too abstract and too difficult for teachers to run.



Clearer targets, visualisation and controlled challenge improved the interaction.

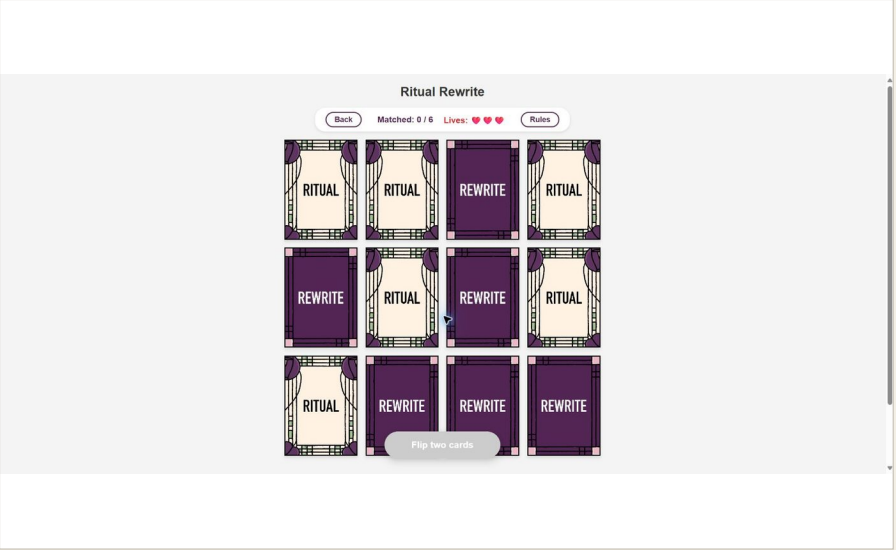
MY CONTRIBUTION

I connected the classroom journey with the browser game.

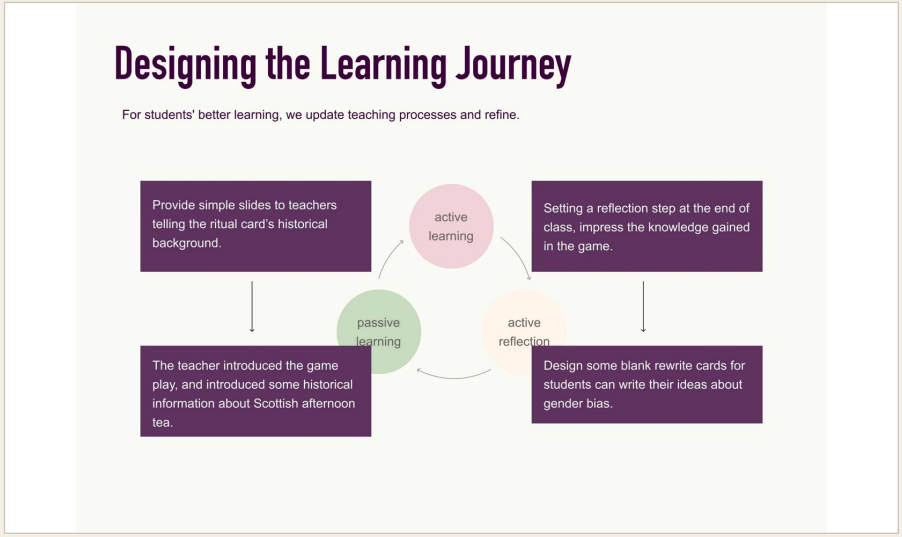
I helped design the teacher launch stage and reject mechanics that did not fit the learning context, and I built the HTML and JavaScript game with AI coding assistance. Fast-click, touch-and-scroll and score-overflow failures became design evidence.

FEASIBILITY DECISION

I argued for a lightweight browser route and printable teacher support over a Unity-only experience. Teacher autonomy and easy access mattered more than adding complex technical features.



The browser prototype runs without accounts or specialist installation.



Teacher-led launch and reflection wrap the active game experience.

FINAL SERVICE

The final service combines a browser game with printed teacher support.

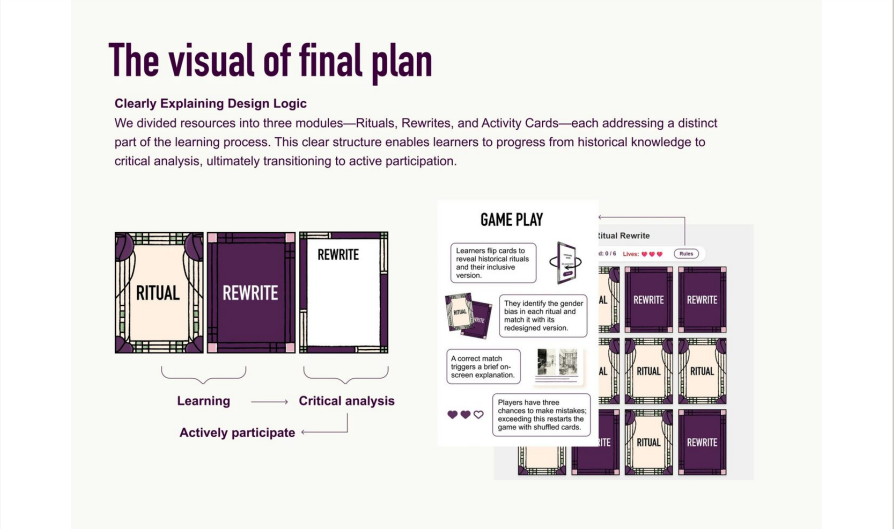
Students interpret ritual cards and make choices in the browser game. Teachers introduce context, manage discussion and use printed support to connect the activity with critical reflection and future hospitality roles.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

Peer simulation improved the concept, but it was not tested with secondary-school students or teachers. No learning, accessibility or curriculum impact is claimed.



The printed kit supports teacher-led framing and discussion.



The final plan links play, learning and critical analysis.

SYSTEMS STUDY / 2026

Myco-Care

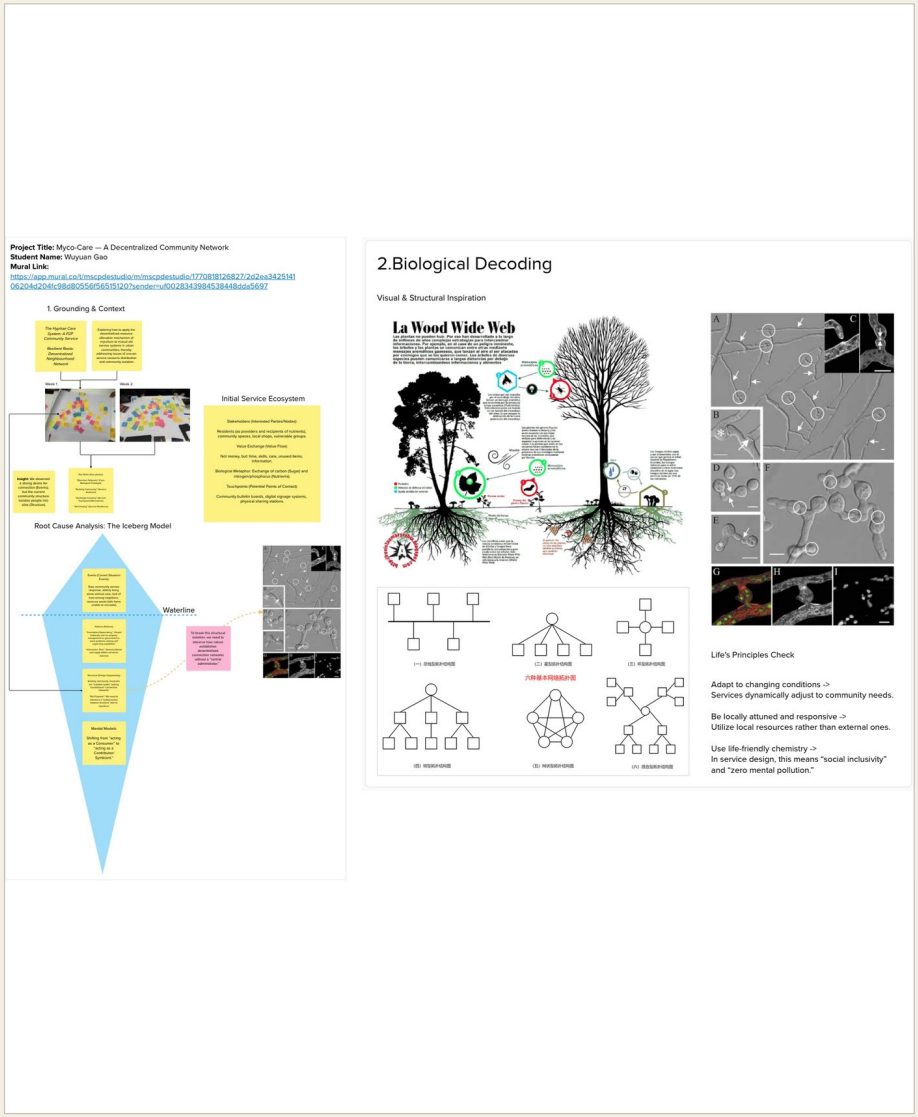
A decentralised community-service concept that translates mycorrhizal exchange, redundancy and pressure signals into a local support network.

DESIGN QUESTION

What if support behaved less like one-way charity and more like resilient exchange?

ROLE

Individual Service Designer



Grounding, context and root-cause analysis for the community network.

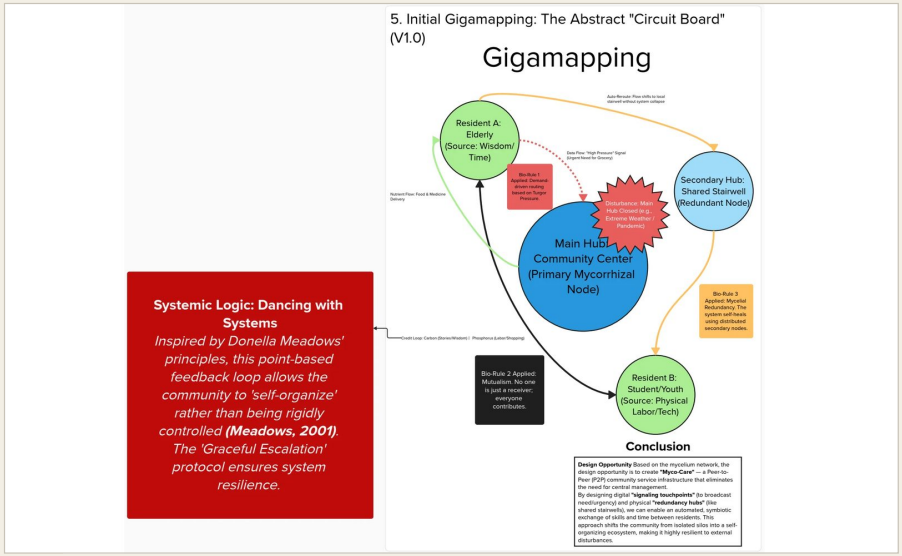
BIOLOGICAL MECHANISM TO SERVICE RULE

Three biological behaviours became three service rules.

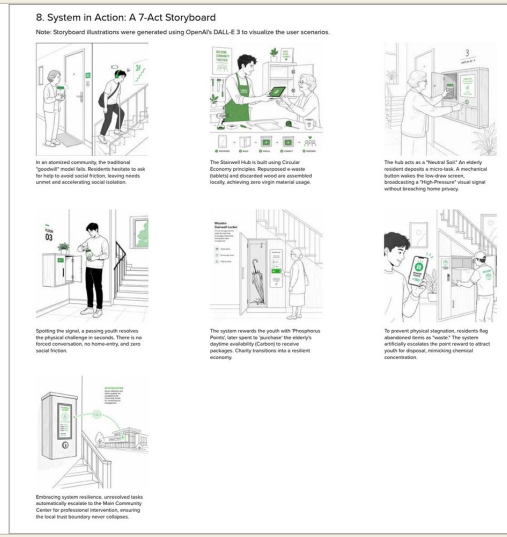
A community centre coordinates the network and refers residents to professional support when needed. Shared stairwell lockers let residents signal needs and exchange items at different times. Older and younger residents contribute time, knowledge, physical help and technical support.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

This is a systems and biomimicry concept study. It was not co-designed or tested with residents, housing providers or community organisations.



The system map shows how needs reroute between residents, a main hub and a redundant stairwell hub.



A seven-act storyboard shows signalling, exchange and escalation in use.

EDUCATION

Glasgow School of Art

MDes Design Innovation and Service Design / 2025-2026 / awarded September 2026

OCAD University

Bachelor of Design (Honours), Graphic Design / 2021-2025

SUPPORTING EXPERIENCE

Nanjing Yindu Ogilvy Advertising / Intern Graphic Designer

May to August 2023. Vehicle graphics, student-facing campus posters, a bar logo and basketball-event posters.

Nanjing Jinguo Graphics / Intern Graphic Designer

August to November 2023. Hospital-event brochures and product-instruction layouts.

CONTACT

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AVAILABILITY

Based in London and available now for full-time, fixed-term and part-time roles.